



Boat, Tent or Box **Schools of the World**

Comprehension Questions

1. The author gives several reasons for needing an alternative to a school building. Give three of these.

2. Who is Inderjit Khurana?

3. How do we know that platform schools have been successful?

4. Why aren't the children in the Stung Mean Chey slum normally in school?

5. How does the Cambodian school encourage parents to send their children?

6. What is the 'School in a Box'? Give three facts about it.



7. What is one technology used in the boat schools programme?

8. Name two difficulties experienced by those running the cave school in China.



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Comprehension - Answers

1. The author gives several reasons for needing an alternative to a school building. Give three of these.

A new school might be needed because of a natural disaster, a war or because the children live in an area far away from regular schools. They might also live in an impoverished area where education is too expensive.

2. Who is Inderjit Khurana?

A teacher and founder of the platform schools in India.

3. How do we know that platform schools have been successful?

The author tells us about the growth of the schools from one platform to many; over 6,000 students have been taught at the schools over the last 30 years; the group has expanded to include job training schemes for older pupils.

4. Why aren't the children in the Stung Mean Chey slum normally in school?

The article mentions that they are normally working to help their families, e.g. collecting aluminium cans for the recyclers. They might also mention the fact that schools require uniform and supplies, which can be prohibitively expensive.

5. How does the Cambodian school encourage parents to send their children?

They provide free rice meals and give a monthly payment for keeping the pupils in school.

6. What is the 'School in a Box'? Give three facts about it.

The 'School in a Box' is a UNICEF incentive, taken to areas where schools are closed for reasons of natural disaster or war. The box can be used as a blackboard when black paint is applied and contains all the important materials for learning (workbooks, pencils, rulers etc).

7. What is one technology used in the boat schools programme?

The boats use wireless technologies and solar panels for electricity. They contain four computers for the use of pupils in lessons.

8. Name two difficulties experienced by those running the cave school in China.

Birds and bats flew over the classroom; there was no electricity or running water; no teachers wanted to work there; there was little equipment and no money to buy any.